Module 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Part A – Professional Email Drafts

The following two emails demonstrate the application of professional email etiquette, including clear subject lines, appropriate salutations, structured body paragraphs, and proper sign-offs.

Email 1 — Assignment Extension Request

Scenario: A student requests an extension on an assignment deadline from their professor.

To: narendrasing@gmail.com
Subject: Request for Assignment Deadline Extension – Data Structures (CS301)

Dear Professor,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a short extension on the upcoming assignment for CS301 – Data Structures, currently due
on Friday, 4 April 2025.

Over the past week, I experienced a medical issue that significantly impacted my ability to complete the work to the standard I hold for myself. I have since recovered and have made considerable progress, but I require two additional days to finalize and review my submission properly.

I kindly request an extension until Sunday, 6 April 2025. I understand this is subject to your discretion, and I am happy to provide documentation if required.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I genuinely value this course and want to ensure my submission reflects the effort it deserves.

Warm regards,
Pranjal Bhatnagar
BTech Computer Science, First Year | Roll No: 25BCE10XXX
Pranjal.123@gmail.com

Email 2 — Summer Internship Application

Scenario: A student expresses interest in a summer internship at a company.

To: internships@techbridgeindia.com
Subject: Application for Summer Internship 2025 – Computer Science Student

Dear Ms. Kapoor,

I am writing to express my interest in a summer internship opportunity at TechBridge India. I am currently pursuing a B.Tech in Computer Science (First Year) at VIT Bhopal, Sehore, with a strong academic record (CGPA: 8.7/10) and a keen interest in software development and data analytics.

I came across TechBridge India's work in enterprise software solutions and was genuinely impressed by your recent projects in AI-assisted business intelligence. I believe my skills in Python, SQL, and machine learning fundamentals — developed through coursework and personal projects — would allow me to contribute meaningfully to your team.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background aligns with your internship openings. I am available full-time from May through July 2025 and am flexible regarding project assignments. Please find my resume and portfolio attached for your consideration.

Thank you for your time. I look forward to the possibility of working with TechBridge India this summer.

Sincerely,
Pranjal Bhatnagar
B.Tech Computer Science, Secon Year
VIT Bhopal, Sehore
Pranjal.bhatnagar@vitbhopal.ac.in

Part B – Social Media Do's and Don'ts

The following checklist outlines responsible social media practices for college students, covering both positive behaviours to adopt and harmful patterns to avoid.

The Checklist

☑ DO's

#	Do	Why It Matters
1	Think before you post — ask yourself, would a professor or employer be comfortable seeing this?	Content can be screenshot and shared permanently, even after deletion.
2	Use privacy settings — regularly review who can see your posts, stories, and personal data.	Limits unwanted exposure of personal information to strangers.
3	Give credit — tag original creators or cite sources when sharing others' content.	Respects intellectual property and builds trust in your network.
4	Maintain a professional profile — keep at least one platform (e.g., LinkedIn) updated and polished.	Recruiters and coordinators routinely check social profiles.
5	Engage constructively — share opinions respectfully, especially on sensitive topics.	Encourages healthy dialogue and protects your online reputation.
6	Fact-check before sharing — verify claims through credible sources before reposting.	Prevents the spread of misinformation within your network.
7	Report harmful content — use platform tools to flag harassment or abusive posts.	Keeps online spaces safer and more respectful for everyone.

DON'Ts

#	Don't	Why It's Harmful
1	Don't share personal details publicly — avoid posting your address, ID, or daily schedule.	Makes you vulnerable to identity theft, stalking, or scams.

#	Don't	Why It's Harmful
2	Don't engage in cyberbullying or online shaming — avoid targeting individuals with mockery or hate.	Causes serious emotional harm and may have legal consequences.
3	Don't post under the influence or in anger — avoid uploading content when emotionally heightened.	Impulsive posts are often regretted and difficult to fully remove.
4	Don't plagiarise — never repost full articles or images and present them as your own.	Violates copyright law and damages your academic integrity.
5	Don't overshare academic materials — avoid posting exam papers or confidential college documents.	May breach institutional policies or non-disclosure agreements.
6	Don't ignore red flags from strangers — avoid accounts that ask for personal favours or information.	Protects against social engineering and online fraud.
7	Don't neglect digital wellness — avoid excessive scrolling that disrupts sleep or study time.	Supports mental health and overall academic performance.

Part B – Reflection: When Poor Digital Communication Causes Real Problems

In 2013, a public relations executive at a major international firm posted a brief, flippant tweet about AIDS just before boarding a long flight to Africa. The post was visible to her thousands of followers and was not intended as a serious remark, but it quickly went viral. By the time she landed and turned on her phone, she had already been dismissed from her position and the tweet had been condemned globally. The incident illustrates several failures of digital etiquette: an absence of empathy for how words might land with a diverse audience, a misplaced assumption that tone translates easily in text, and underestimating the public nature and permanence of social media posts. Had she paused to consider the impact of her words — or simply not posted at all — both her reputation and her career would have remained intact. This case is a stark reminder that digital communication demands the same care, and sometimes more, as any face-to-face interaction.